

A careful analysis of the inbound ground controller tapes showed that there were three United Airline airplanes taxiing to the maintenance hanger during this time, United maintenance 97 (a B747), United maintenance 5 (a B777), and United maintenance 44, (a B777). Cf. Figures 3 and 5 for all locations.¹⁸ We are concerned only with that latter which contained witnesses B and C.

At 4:48:05 pm a male voice allegedly coming from one of the two above airplanes broke into an ongoing conversation between Gateway flight 5668 and the inbound ground controller. Here is that interaction starting at about 4:47:39 pm where: (A/C1 = Gateway 5668; : A/C2 = United 44; T = inbound ground controller)

T "Gateway 5668."

A/C1 "Gateway 5668."

T "Yeh... look out your window. Do you see anything above United concourse? They actually, believe it or not, they called us and said, somebody observed a flying disc about a thousand feet above the, ah... gate Charley 17. Do you see anything over there?"

 pause of about 5 sec.

A/C1 "Not that I can tell. I thought my job was stressful" (laughter)

Approx. 4:48:05 pm

A/C2 (witness B)¹⁹ "Oh, we saw it a half hour ago"

T "Who saw it?"

A/C2 "A whole bunch of us over at the, ah Charley concourse."

T "Really? You guys did? who is this?"

A/C2 "United taxi mechanics (5 sec. pause). We thought it was a balloon but we're not sure."

Note that a half-hour before this statement by the alleged eye witness would be about 4:18pm

¹⁸ An airport diagram for O'Hare is found at: <<http://204.108.4.16/d-tp/0704/00166AD.PDF>>

¹⁹ At this point witness B and C are either at gate C10 or at the United maintenance hanger. NARCAP's reconstruction assumes the latter.

UAP in the present incident did not conform to these regulations.

According to an Associated Press article of July 3, 2006, quoting government statistics, O'Hare was the busiest airport in the nation during the first six months of 2006 with 477,001 flights (take-offs and landings). Wendy Abrams of the Chicago Department of Aviation said, "It (ORD) is a key aviation hub both nationally and internationally." To put this huge number of flights into a national perspective, consider that for the first ten months of 2006 U. S. airlines operated 8,822 million scheduled domestic and international flights³¹ at all of its airports and 890,300 flights just in October 2006 alone. O'Hare's air traffic controllers typically handle about ninety six arrivals per hour or one every 38 seconds, usually on multiple runways. They are kept extremely busy.

O'Hare International Airport currently has four passenger terminals. Three are used by approximately thirty major and regional airlines. The International Terminal (Concourse M) serves approximately twenty seven airlines.

As of November 7, 2006 there were twenty seven cargo carriers operating in and out of ORD³². Official statistics point out that there were 30,537 arrivals and 30,535 departures in November 2006 from its six runways (see Table 2 in Section 3.5.1). The extremely large size of these numbers emphasize the critical importance of the nation's air traffic control system that is designed to keep aircraft from colliding both on the ground and in the air. As this report will show, the radar system at O'Hare was incapable of detecting the presence of an airborne, hovering object of significant size, nor was the object seen from the tower. If an object cannot be seen visually or on radar it does not officially exist and no specific actions can be taken to warn airplanes of its existence.

3.2.1 FAA Facility Operations Record.

Figure 8 is a certified copy of the ORD tower '*Daily Record of Facility Operation*' for November 7, 2006.³³ It contains several interesting points:

(1) At UTC 2245 (4:45 PM) the record states that "SUE FROM UNITED RAMP TOWER CALLED TO INQUIRE IF WE HAD SEEN A FLYING DISC OVER THE UNITED TERMINAL IN THE VICINITY OF GATE C17 AT ABOUT ONE THOUSAND FEET. I REPLIED THAT WE HAD NOT./DH. (2) UTC 2303 (5:03 PM) QAR CLSD ABOUT DISC. (3) E. GISH ON WCLC.

³¹ Bureau of Transportation Statistics, January 11, 2007 press release.

³² http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/O'Hare_International_Airport.

³³ Received on March 5, 2007 from F.O.I.A. request 2007-001234GL.

As Ledger, a pilot and one of NARCAP's technical specialists³⁶ has pointed out, the presence of the alleged UAP might have resulted in a change in departures on runways 27L and 32R since the UAP above gate C17 could be seen from the takeoff end of each. The airplanes taking off from 32L would fly increasingly close to the location of the UAP as they climbed out such that the flight crew could look up at the bottom of the object from a distance of only about 1,500 feet away. As he points out in Appendix F.4, he would be extremely concerned about the intentions of this hovering object and the possibility that it might suddenly veer toward the airplane taking off and endangering his airplane, passengers, and crew. Executing a sudden avoidance maneuver at such low altitudes and airspeeds is fraught with danger. Nevertheless, no evidence could be found in official records that any modifications were made to any airport departure operations around the time of this incident. However, United Airlines flight 446 was delayed at least seventeen minutes from its scheduled push-back time for some unknown reason!

3.2.2. United Flight 446

This aircraft was at gate C17 and scheduled to depart for Charlotte, NC at 4:10 pm according to published airline flight data. This flight departure time was actually delayed to 4:27 pm. (or slightly longer?) According to a FOIA recording for the outbound ground controller's station, the following taxi instructions were given at about 4:30:19 pm: (A/C = flight 446; T = tower)

T "United 446, O'Hare ground. Thirty two L, T10, turn right on Alpha, go to Alpha 7 for Tango."

A/C "Alpha, Alpha 7, Tango (garbled) 446."

This radio communication indicates that the B737-500 airplane: (1) had finally pushed back from the gate area and had moved into the active taxiway area between concourse B and C, i.e., it had uncoupled from its pusher and was ready to move forward. (2) was headed for the T10 entry onto runway 32L for takeoff via taxiway Alpha, Alpha 7, and Tango.

Just about one and one-half minutes later at 4:31:44 pm the tower again contacted United 446 with the following instructions:

T "United 446. Come down on Tango. Give way to Northwest. Follow him. 132.7."

A/C "Follow Northwest, 132.7. Good day."

These instructions indicated that flight 446: (1) had to follow a Northwest Airlines airplane down taxiway Tango toward the SE which would have been facing away from gate C17, making it impossible for the crew to look back in that direction, and (2) was authorized to change radio frequencies to 132.7 which is the departure controller's frequency. That is, United flight 446 was now under the control of a different tower controller who would authorize his takeoff from runway 32L. We may assume that United 446 took off at about 4:34 pm.

³⁶ Don Ledger, personal communications, March 1, 2007.

Table 3

Recording No. 1

Phone Conversation Between United Zone Controller (R)
and FAA Area Supervisor (T1) in O'Hare Tower
(Parentheses enclose editor's comments or uncertain transcription)

Start time: 4:30 pm

T1 "Tower, this is Dave" (initials DH: see Daily Record of Facility Operations, time 2245)
 R "Hey Dave, this is Sue in the United tower"
 T1 "Hey Sue"
 R "Hey, did you see a flying disc out by C17?"
 T1 "Oh, it starts Sue. (laughter) Oh, we're Sorry Sue, (feminine laughter
 in background) A flying ... you're seeing flying discs?"
 R "Well, that's what a pilot in the ramp area at C17 told us. They saw some flying
 disc above them. But we can't see above us."
 T1 "Common Sue"
 R (You didn't see it?)
 T1 "Hey, you guys been celebrating the holidays or anything, or what? You're celebrating
 Christmas today? I haven't seen anything Sue, and if I did I wouldn't admit to it.
 No, I have not seen any flying disc at gate C17. (Sue continues to laugh)
 Unless you've got a new aircraft you're bringing out that I don't know about."
 R "No" (Sue continues to laugh)
 T "No, I haven't seen anything Sue (he becomes more serious) (feminine laughter
 continues) ...nothing I know about"
 R "Alright"
 T1 "If I do I don't know what I'll do. (both laugh) I guess I'll back it up with you. . . but
 I'll keep an eye out"
 R "Alright" (continues to laugh)
 T1 "Alright"

End Time: approx. 4:31:10

The second recording was for the period 4:47 to 4:49 pm (lasting about 87 seconds) between the United Ramp Tower and the Operations Manager in the tower. It is presented in Table 4.

Table 4

Recording No. 3

Phone Conversation Between United Ramp Tower (R)
and FAA Area Supervisor (T) in O'Hare Tower

Start time: 4:47 pm

T "Go ahead, tower, Dwight"
R "Dwight?"
T "Yes"
R "What happened to Dave? Did he have to take a break because I called him?"
T "No"
R "This is Sue from United" (laughter)
T "Yes" (serious tone)
R (12 sec. pause) "There was a disc out there flying around"
T "There was a what?"
R "A disc"
T "A disc?"
R "Yeh"
T "Can you hang on one second?"
R "Sure"

(33 sec. pause) Contains ramp tower background chatter "He's working traffic",
"OK, I'll be right back" "Alright"

T "OK, I'm sorry what can I do for you?"
R "I'm sorry, there was, I told Dave, there was a disc flying outside above Charley 17
and he thought I was pretty much high. But, um, I'm not high and I'm not
drinking."
T "Yeh"
R "So, someone got a picture of it. So if you guys see it out there"
T "A disc, like a Frisbee?"
R "Like a UFO type thing"
T "Yeh, OK."
R "He got a picture of it." (laughs)
T "How, how, how high above Charley 17?"
R "Well, it was above our tower. So"
T "Yeh"
R "So, if you happen to see anything (she continues to laugh)"
T "You know, I'll keep a peeled eye for that"
R "OK"
T "Bye"

MD-80 from your right and then continue."

3:57:50 A/C2 "Give way to the MD-80, United forty four."

3:57:52 T "United six twenty three, (instructions) ".. taxi to the gate."

3:58:04 A/C "Gateway 5668...(garbled) ... penalty box...we go to the north port."

3:58:09 T "Gateway 5668, you can use Alpha to northport and use caution for the, ah UFO." (spoken in a matter of fact tone)

3:58:13 A/C "For the northport. We'll take a look." (slight chuckle)

(Note: The controller seems to be giving someone with him a situation briefing at this point.)

3:58:18 T "I got the chicken liner (garbled)... ah information. Ah, we're ... I got a bit of information here. We're up to date here... (Currently?) our plan (here? or weird?)" ...(interrupted by call)

3:58:23 A/C "Ten-forty-four is on Bravo .. ah, Foxtrot one, Bravo."

3:58:27 T "Ten forty-four... continue via Bravo. Taxi to the gate."

3:58:30 A/C (garbled) (pilot acknowledges instruction)

3:58:31 T "Ah, these guys. (were on?)... (interrupted by incoming A/C call)

(Note. It is now clear that a new person has arrived at the Inbound Ground Controller's Position. The controller is filling him in on what is taking place.)

3:58:32 A/C " Eagle four nineteen on Bravo going to Delta seven."

3:58:35 T "Eagle four nineteen taxi via Bravo."

3:58:37 T "We got a couple guys on maintenance .. down on..(garbled) .. over at tango over here. We got a United maintenance flight... I think it's a ..." (brief pause)

(Controller continues to explain what is happening to second person).

3:58:44 T (speaks louder here as to a different person) "Yeh, United maintenance flight that's just joining Alpha from the International, what's your number again?"

3:58:47 A/C "United maintenance forty-four."

3:58:49 T "That's four-four, thank you."

3:58:50 A/C "Alright."

3:58:51 T "United forty four is goin' around the north (fork?) ... ah, yeh, Eagle and Skywest over here comin around this way. He's turnin in ... we've really got no other gate holds."

3:58:57 [second voice] "Alright."

3:58:59 T "Somebody reported a UFO or a flying disc above Charley concourse, seriously."

3:59:02 [second voice] "Excellent."

3:59:03 T "Yeh. ... Um, so nobody..."

3:59:04 [second voice] "I'll keep my eyes open."

3:59:04 T "Nobody can see it. But use caution."

3:59:06 [second voice] "Alright."

3:59:07 T "Um... and a... (laughter by two men) "that's pretty much it (garbled conversation)

3:59:11 (interrupted by female pilot voice)

4:47:39 T "Gateway 5668."

A/C1 "Gateway 5668."

T "Yeh... look out your window. Do you see anything above United concourse? They actually, believe it or not, they called us and said, somebody observed a flying disc about a thousand feet above the, ah... gate Charley 17. Do you see anything over there?"

pause of about 5 sec.

A/C1 "Not that I can tell. I thought my job was stressful" (laughter)

4:48:05 pm A/C2 (witness B)⁴⁵ "Oh, we saw it a half hour ago"

T "Who saw it?"

A/C2 "A whole bunch of us over at Charley concourse."

T "Really? You guys did? Who is this?"

A/C2 "United taxi mechanics (5 sec. pause). We thought it was
a balloon but we're not sure."

As discussed in Section 2.0, it is very likely that the taxi mechanic who spoke with ground control at 4:48:05 in Table 6 was witness B based on the similarity of details provided. If the estimate that they had seen the UAP thirty minutes earlier is accurate then the time would be at about 4:18pm.

The inbound ground controller remarked to the pilot of Gateway 5668 that the tower had been called about the presence of the object over C17 and that is what prompted his request to look for the object. The first communication occurred at 4:30 pm and is transcribed in Table 3. A second and third communication from United Airlines occurred at 4:47 pm and 4:52 pm, respectively (Table 4 and 5). Exactly when the inbound controller first learned about the UAP cannot be determined but there are a number of relatively long periods of silence where this might have occurred, all of them were before United personnel made the first call to the tower. While NARCAP acknowledges that there are normal periods of high and low taxi activity that call for instructions from the controller the following blank periods become obvious when heard as part of a full hour's worth of recording. At 4:21:49, for instance, the controller said nothing for sixteen seconds; then, as if to catch up with his workload, he speaks faster and seems somewhat distracted immediately afterward. The next period of quiet begins at 4:24:07 for seventeen seconds followed by him thinking he had missed a pilot's comment when no such comment had been made by the pilot. The next period of quiet begins at 4:24:36 for eighteen seconds followed at 4:27:19 for twenty-four seconds and then at 4:28:44 for thirty-two seconds. These quiet periods would not seem so unusual except that for most of the preceding and following minutes (in the hour's recording) he was talking almost continuously.

The final recording received through NARCAP's first FOIA request was related only to TRACON radio communications with United flight 446. The entire certified⁴⁶ recording began at 4:25 pm and ended at 4:40 pm. However, the only radio communication with United Flight 446 found was a brief

⁴⁵ At this point witness B and C are either at gate C10 or at the United maintenance hanger. NARCAP's reconstruction assumes the latter.

⁴⁶ Certified by Sharon Graham, Quality Program Assurance Specialist, Chicago TRACON.

radio contact between the jet and TRACON at about 4:37:15 pm soon after its takeoff. It is transcribed as follows:

Pilot "This is United 446, checking in with you. We're passing two thousand for five thousand."

TRACON "United 446, Chicago Departure, end of contact."

If the cockpit crew of United Flight 446 parked at gate C17 did see the UAP as suggested earlier they apparently did not comment about it to the TRACON controller.⁴⁷ There is also no mention of any UAP between this controller and other taxiing aircraft on this particular frequency.⁴⁸ The tape ends with ATC instructions for flight 446 to level off at 13,000 feet altitude. These official communications tend to support the FAA's contention that they knew nothing about the presence of a UAP over the airport.

4.0 Weather Conditions

William Puckett⁴⁹
NARCAP Research Associate

The greater Chicago area was under the influence of a stable air mass with low pressure gradients. The air mass was moist below about 2,000 feet (AGL) and quite dry above 2,000 feet. Surface winds were below ten knots in the lower 5,000 feet. A few light rain showers had occurred earlier in the day. Cloud ceilings were 1,000 to 2,000 feet⁵⁰ with visibility restricted to three (3) to five (5) miles in haze and fog. Weather data for this and location and date from the Automated Surface Observation Station (ASOS) showed a cloud ceiling of 1,900 feet AGL at 4:51 pm. This overcast had been rising gradually since about 10:00 am. Additional regional weather data is included in Appendix A (prepared by W. Puckett). Table 7 presents the atmospheric lapse rate data for Davenport, Iowa on November 7, 2006 at 6:00 pm CST.

⁴⁷ Given the unwritten censure and ridicule that usually accompanies reporting UAP to management pilots typically remain quiet about what they see. Cf. (Roe, 2001) for background information directly related to this unhealthy negative reporting bias.

⁴⁸ A second FOIA request was made to FAA O'Hare office on March 8, 2007. It confirmed that nothing was said about the UAP either by inbound or outbound ground controllers other than one brief query to an airplane with call sign Gateway 5668 at 4:47:39 pm. (See Table 6 for details).

⁴⁹ Atmospheric scientist, MS, retired.

⁵⁰ Cloud ceiling is determined using a laser ceilometer. Cf. <[http:// www.allweatherinc.com/meteorological/8340_ceilometer.html](http://www.allweatherinc.com/meteorological/8340_ceilometer.html)>

cloud layer where the craft had been, The hole disappeared a few minutes later.” As discussed in Section 2.0, one highly qualified witness (B) confirmed that he and witness (C) saw the hole at about 4:20 pm. He said, "I guess it had just left." Estimates given above (Section 2.0) for the time of departure of the UAP and a fairly definite time when the hole in the cloud was still visible range from five to ten (mean = seven and one-half) minutes!

The story of this unusual sighting broke on January 1, 2007, in the Chicago Tribune.⁵² According to the Tribune story, reports by airlines employees state that “A flying saucer-like [sic] object hovered low over O’Hare International Airport for several minutes before bolting through the clouds with such an intense energy that it left an eerie hole in overcast skies...the object [was] estimated to be hovering 1,500 feet above the ground...[and] was seen to suddenly accelerate straight up through the solid overcast skies, which the FAA reported had 1,900-foot cloud ceiling at the time...It left behind an open hole of clear air in the cloud layer...[that] disappeared within a few minutes.” The Tribune attributes one airline employee with the statement, “It was like somebody punched a hole in the sky.”

5.2 Historical Background. Although the multiple eyewitness accounts of this HIC may be unusual, they are not unprecedented. Reports of this odd manifestation have been associated with UAP sightings as far back as 1947, and as far afield as Newfoundland, England and Scotland.

A declassified Army Air Force Intelligence Investigation Report held in the files of the Center for UFO Studies (CUFOS)⁵³, provides a record of one such sighting that occurred approximately six miles SSW of Harmon Field, Newfoundland (1388th AAF Bu, NBC, ATLD, ATC. Harmon Field, Newfoundland) on July 10, 1947. According to the signed statements by witnesses – John E. Woodruff, Chief Mechanic, Pan American Airways; John N. Mehrman, Jr. Supervisor and Mechanic, Trans World Airway; and, Robert W. Leidy, Station Mechanic, Pan American Airways – at approximately 5:00 in the afternoon, Woodruff saw a “translucent disk like a wheel traveling at a terrific speed and opened the clouds as it went through the air.” The witnesses stopped the vehicle in which they were traveling and got out to observe the object. Though Woodruff was the only witness to actually see the “disk”, both Mehrman and Leidy saw the hole left in the cloud layer upon the departure of the object. Mehrman reported “the clouds were very scattered and were about 8,000 to 10,000 feet, the object passed through and cut the cloud leaving a gap where you could see the blue sky, like a knife had cut it. The edges were feathered similar to a weld, as if you cut a weld in half.” Leidy stated that “you could see the trail right through the cloud, it looked to be traveling in a big circle and it left sharp edges to the clouds.”

An article in the Fort Pierce (FL) Tribune from Feb 16, 2007 quotes from a formerly classified U.S. Government report released under the Freedom of Information Act, and states, in part:

“... on Oct. 28, 1947, Lt. Col. George Garrett prepared a so-called Intelligence Collection Memorandum for Air Force Intelligence which listed some commonly reported features of flying discs: "The ability to group together very quickly in a tight formation when more than one aircraft are together; evasive action ability indicates the possibility of being manually operated, or possibly by electronics or remote control;

⁵² Jon Hilkevitch. “In the sky! A bird? A plane? A...UFO?” Chicago Tribune. 1/1/2007

⁵³ Col. W. R. Clingerman and Lt. Col. E. G. Nabell, of Hqrs., Air Material Command, Wright Field, Dayton, Ohio. “Flying Saucers.” July 1947

B. United Airlines Published Departures and Arrivals
Between ORD and Charlotte, NC for 9 November 2006

C. Investigation of Photographic and Other Hoaxes

Ted Roe, Executive Director

Aviation incident investigators who are examining cases that might involve UAP are sometimes confronted with the added task of assessing photographic evidence. Technology has made digital cameras quite common and it is possible that some UAP events may be photographed or videotaped by pilots and/or the traveling public.⁸³ As UAP are currently a poorly documented phenomenon, investigators that find themselves confronted by photographic evidence must determine the authenticity of the photograph as well as the veracity of the photographer/witness. As Sue, a United Airlines ramp tower employee said to Dwight in the O'Hare control tower that day, "...someone got a picture of it... he got a picture of it."⁸⁴ (cf. Table 4)

In the case of the O'Hare incident, this situation has become even more complicated with the appearance of alleged photographs of the incident that were submitted by anonymous sources.⁸⁵ Further analysis of these photographs has demonstrated that most of them are the product of image manipulation and fraudulent claims. Often these hoaxers acquire photographs from internet sources and manipulate them with software, based upon public witness statements, to appear to be consistent with publicized reports. This situation will be addressed further in a future NARCAP report.

There are several approaches that can be taken to mitigate these potential hoaxes. First and foremost the aviation community needs to accept that aviation incidents involving UAP profiles do occur and deserve close examination. In the case of the O'Hare matter, if witnesses had been encouraged to forward their reports to a prepared and sympathetic aviation incident entity like the FAA's Aviation Safety Reporting System or even an agency such as NARCAP that practices rigorous confidentiality and information management and the normal course of investigation had ensued, public speculations and complications arising from that speculation like hoaxed photos could have been all but eliminated.

⁸³ See (Haines and Puckett, 2007) for one such event.

⁸⁴ This assertion probably originated from witness A at the scene. If so, Sue is referring to one of the flight crew of United flight 446 and not from other ramp personnel (who would not necessarily have cameras available on the job.)

⁸⁵ As witness J.H. states in Appendix E, [I] "We ended up with a group of about seven people all together standing with us watching it. One fellow had a digital camera. He was taking many pictures. That much I do know. I saw other people taking photos too."

his cell phone out, and those windows aren't very conducive to much more than a quick shot at an angle). But the same object did look darker when I was more beneath it than it did when I was viewing it at a more sidelong angle from Mannheim. What I do know for sure is that a number of people in the parking lot photographed the object, and I encourage them to release their photos.

4. 24 -- Eyewitness posted on January 26, 2007 at 21:59 [single post](#) (Complete)

Skyway, it was when I was heading north on Mannheim that I got the best sidelong look at it, and it did look quite a bit like (I so hate to type this, lol) the ostensible cell phone photo --- evenly ovoid, overall lighter gray, a bit too distant to make out any features, if indeed features there were. From the parking lot, though, I was closer, but at a more underneath vantage point than a sideview one... from there, since I could still see it somewhat from the side but could see the bottom better, and it looked a little more disklike from the bottom, but there was enough sideview to see that it was a bit "higher" than the stereotypical flying disk... a little thicker than a Frisbee proportionately, in other words, and with much smoother curves. I saw no features whatsoever --- as I said before, there was something about the texture that halfway perplexed me, because while it seemed by its shading almost reflective, it didn't really seem to have a mirror like surface. Words really do escape me at some points regarding this, and I'm fairly well a walking dictionary, so that's noteworthy.

As to how I felt when I saw it --- initially on the road I was curious and a bit excited by it, because it was fairly apparent that it was something quite different. When I watched it from the parking lot, there was simply no doubt in me that I was seeing, under practically ideal circumstances, a craft that was under control, that was capable of moving in ways that would, with normal (known) technology, cause a human body quite a bit of discomfort, if not broken bones, and that it was, in fact, extraterrestrial in origin. I really thought it was going to land, and the friend who had ridden to the airport with me said at one point "This will change everything." Emotionally, part of me wanted it to come down fifty feet from me, and another part of me wanted to run and hide. Not very scientific-minded of me, granted, but it had that effect.

5. 23 -- Eyewitness posted on January 26, 2007 at 22:24 [single post](#) (Complete)

JBird, yes, sorry, less than the usual number of planes during the last minutes of the sighting. In the parking lot, when first seeing it people made comments, but we were mostly all rather dumbstruck after the first few moments of watching, because for a number of us it wasn't a superquick glimpse, it was an ongoing and static sighting, with a realness to it that basically just shortcircuited your speech center. After it swept up and off, no one near me even said anything like "What was that?" It was difficult to find words. My friend and I reparked (I'd parked a bit far from the terminal entrance to continue watching the object) and each recounted to the other exactly what we'd just seen... I think it must have been sort of our reality test. We've discussed it every single day since then. My friend on the incoming plane said he would nose about a bit to find out more if possible, but he's not a United pilot, nor is he based in Chicago, so I'm not sure how much he'll reasonably be able to learn.